Water Pollution

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Untreated Sewage & Excess Fertiliser

- Human activities have led to the pollution of land, water and air
- Pollution comes from a variety of sources, including industry and manufacturing processes, waste and discarded rubbish, chemicals from farming practices, nuclear fall-out, and untreated sewage

Pollutant	Source / Cause	Effect
Untreated sewage	Lack of sewage treatment (poor infrastructure/funding) means sewage enters rivers or streams.	Increases bacteria → reduces oxygen in water → kills aquatic life. This process is known as **eutrophication**.

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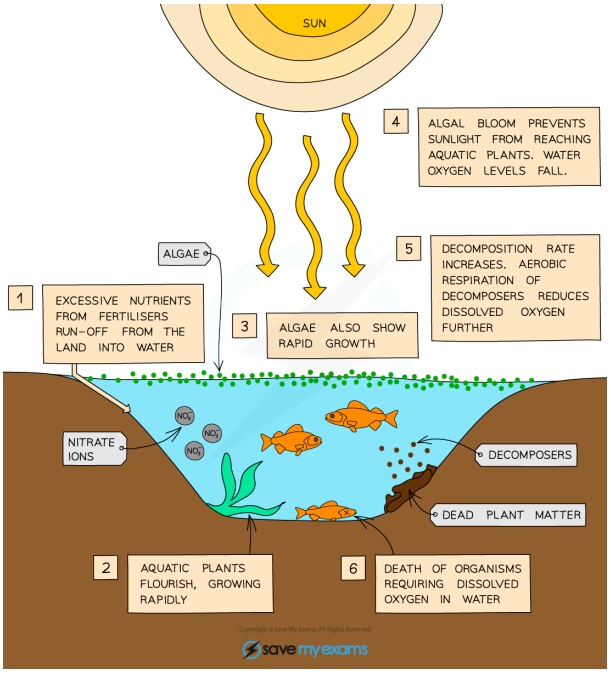
Got it

		depletion → death of aquatic organisms. Another case of **eutrophication**.
Methane	Released by cattle farming, rice paddies, and landfills.	Potent **greenhouse gas**, contributes to climate change.
Carbon dioxide	Produced by burning fossil fuels or trees (land clearance).	Also a **greenhouse gas**, contributing to **global warming and climate change**.

Eutrophication: Extended

- Runoff of fertiliser from farmland enters the water and causes **increased growth of algae** and water plants
- The resulting 'algal bloom' **blocks sunlight** so water plants on the bottom start to die, as does the algae when competition for nutrients becomes too intense
- As water plants and algae die in greater numbers, **decomposing bacteria increase in number** and **use up the dissolved oxygen** whilst respiring aerobically
- As a result there is less oxygen dissolved in water, so **aquatic organisms such as fish and insects may be unable to breathe** and would die



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